MADHYA PRADESH TOURISM BOARD

Government of Madhya Pradesh, Bhopal

PROJECT EXAMINATION NOTE

Proposed Maikal–Sarhi Narmada Cruise & Eco-Tourism Circuit

Jabalpur (Bargi) – Payli – Tintni (Tindni) – Sarhi, Kanha

Particular	Details
Meeting	05 November 2026 (Thursday), 01:00 PM
Venue	Madhya Pradesh Tourism Board, Bhopal
Project Proponent	Shri Ashish Mahawar, Arthmitra Advisors LLP
Reference presentation	“From Maikal’s waters to Sarhi’s wild”, September 2026, 56 pages
Purpose	For briefing, preliminary examination, inter-agency consultation and identification of further requirements
Document status	Working note for official consideration; not an approval, sanction, allotment or commitment

Prepared for consideration of the competent authority

1. Purpose and Executive Summary

The proposal submitted by Arthmitra Advisors LLP envisages an integrated water-and-road eco-tourism circuit connecting MPT Maikal Resort at Bargi, an intermediate halt at Payli, a proposed landing point near Tintni/Tindni in Mandla district, and MPT Jungle Resort at Sarhi near Kanha Tiger Reserve.

The concept combines cruise operations on the Bargi reservoir/backwaters of the Narmada with resort upgradation, waterfront hospitality, wellness and cultural experiences, and onward road connectivity to Sarhi. The proponent has indicated low-emission/solar-electric vessels, local employment and low-impact tourism as project objectives.

The proposal may be examined as a potential tourism circuit leveraging existing public tourism assets and established visitor activity at Maikal. However, any further consideration must be based on verified asset ownership and availability, the WAPCOS feasibility report, applicable inland-vessel and navigation requirements, environmental and wildlife restrictions, a bankable DPR and a transparent legally permissible selection/allotment process.

1.1 Key points for the meeting

- The proponent's presentation is a concept proposal. The requested lease, jetty rights, navigation permission and financial support have not been approved by this note.
- MPT Maikal Resort and the existing Boat Club provide an established tourism base. Their current operations, occupancy, revenue, asset status and operational arrangements should be verified from the concerned operating agency.
- It has been informed that WAPCOS undertook a feasibility study and that the route was found technically feasible. The final signed report, scope, route alignment, survey season, assumptions and recommendations should be obtained and examined before the feasibility position is formally recorded.
- The presentation describes approximately 67 km of water travel (Maikal–Payli approximately 12 km; Payli–Tintni approximately 55 km) followed by approximately 63 km by road to Sarhi. These are proponent-stated indicative figures.
- The separate route particulars supplied for Bargi Dam–Tindni refer to a 90 km cruise stretch and identify Harduli, Payli, Old Payli Island, Lanka Island and Tindni. These route descriptions and distances require reconciliation against the WAPCOS report and a geo-referenced map.
- The spelling/location nomenclature appears as Tintni, Tindni and Tidni in different references. The official village/jetty name and coordinates should be confirmed with the district administration and land-owning authority.

2. Project Background and Concept

The concept presentation titled "From Maikal's waters to Sarhi's wild" (Arthmitra Advisors LLP, September 2026) positions Maikal as the gateway to a combined Narmada backwater and Kanha tourism experience. It proposes improving the guest experience at Maikal, developing cruise products, providing an intermediate waterside halt at Payli, creating a landing/transfer point at Tintni and upgrading the destination experience at Sarhi.

2.1 Indicative journey and route

Segment	Mode / indicative distance	Indicative duration / remarks
MPT Maikal Resort to Payli Guest House	Water / approx. 12 km	40–50 minutes, as stated in the deck
Payli Guest House to Tintni landing	Water / approx. 55 km	3–3.5 hours, as stated in the deck
Tintni landing to MPT Jungle Resort, Sarhi	Road / approx. 63 km	About 1.5 hours, via NH-30 / Mandla bypass / MD4023 as stated
Overall journey	Approx. 67 km water + 63 km road	Approx. 5–6 hours plus stops, as stated by the proponent

The route and travel times above are reproduced from the proponent's presentation and are not independently validated in this note. They should be checked against the WAPCOS report, seasonal water levels, navigational constraints, landing conditions and actual road conditions.

2.2 Route locations identified in the supplementary project inputs

- Harduli village / Maikal-side embarkation area near Payli Guest House.
- Payli Guest House and the Payli backwater area as an intermediate halt.
- Old Payli Island and Lanka Island as possible experience locations, subject to land title, access, ecological sensitivity and permissions.
- Tintni/Tindni, Mandla district, as the proposed water-to-road transfer/landing point.

- MPT Jungle Resort, Sarhi, as the proposed destination accommodation asset near the Sarhi gate of Kanha.

3. Existing Assets and Proposed Development Components

Location / asset	Existing position / proposal	Issues to be verified
MPT Maikal Resort, Bargi	Existing MP Tourism resort; proposal for renovation, waterfront dining, cultural/museum experience, wellness and upgraded guest facilities.	Asset owner/custodian, operating agency, current lease/contract, condition, occupancy, revenue, repair backlog, permissible capex and procurement route.
Maikal waterfront / existing jetty	Existing jetty/mooring infrastructure is shown in the deck; proposed as cruise embarkation and mooring point, with charging and shore-control functions.	Ownership, structural condition, design capacity, safety, navigation interface, access rights, utility availability and permissions.
Payli Guest House / nearby land	Proposed intermediate halt, guest facility and waterside experience; supplementary inputs mention Old Payli Guest House or nearby land.	NVDA/other ownership, title, encumbrances, land schedule, current use, access, utilities, submergence/reservoir-level impacts and ecological constraints.
Old Payli and Lanka Islands	Supplementary inputs refer to potential island-based camping and water-sports opportunities.	Exact parcel boundaries, ownership/custody, island status, seasonal accessibility, forest/environmental status, carrying capacity and activity permissions.
Tintni/Tindni landing / jetty	Proposed disembarkation and transfer point for onward road journey to Sarhi.	Correct location/name, ownership, existing jetty status, safe landing, approach road, parking, passenger amenities and land availability.
MPT Jungle Resort, Sarhi	Existing MPT property; proposal for renovation/upgradation and additional hospitality, wellness and nature-based experiences.	Asset status and operator, forest/wildlife jurisdiction, approved land-use, construction limits, access, waste/water management and activity restrictions.

4. Cruise Vessel Concept and Operations

Vessel / product	Concept described in presentation	Information still required
Luxury yacht / event cruise	Up to 20 guests; lounge cabin, event/party use and small open deck.	General arrangement, hull type, dimensions, draft, propulsion, stability, certified passenger capacity, survey/class basis, crew complement and operating envelope.
Luxury river boat house	Three rooms; slower cruising; pantry, kitchen and washroom; intended for longer journeys.	Detailed drawings, accommodation/fire safety, sanitation and waste system, endurance, emergency exits, lifesaving appliances, mooring and overnight-operation permissions.
Solar-electric / low-emission operation	Solar panels, battery-electric propulsion, shore charging and low-wake operation are stated aspirations.	Power and energy balance, battery chemistry and fire protection, charging load, backup propulsion, range in adverse conditions, battery disposal and technical certification.

The presentation also refers to certified stable vessels, GPS/CCTV/radio-linked shore control, rescue boat standby, licensed crew, passenger manifests, life jackets, evacuation drills and weather-based sailing restrictions. These are proposed safety measures and must be converted into an approved vessel-specific safety management and emergency response plan.

The separate supplementary route note refers to a different initial fleet concept: four luxury day/night cruise vessels with four private cabins, lounge/dining and accommodation for 8–10 passengers each, and one day cruise vessel for approximately 30 passengers. This differs from the September 2026 presentation's two-vessel concept (up to 20 guests and a three-room river boat house). The proponent should submit one reconciled fleet plan and identify which proposal is current.

5. Feasibility and Technical Status

It has been informed that a feasibility study for the route was undertaken by WAPCOS and that the route was found technically feasible. The WAPCOS report is stated to be available. This information should be treated as a reported project input until the final report is obtained, authenticated and examined by the competent technical authorities.

5.1 Documents / checks required from WAPCOS report

- Final report title, reference number, date, issuing office and complete annexures/drawings.

- Exact route alignment, chainage, coordinates, waterway distance and proposed embarkation/disembarkation points.
- Hydrographic/bathymetric survey methodology, survey dates and coverage of high-, normal- and low-water conditions.
- Minimum navigable depth, channel width, submerged/obstructed areas, draft restrictions and seasonal operating window.
- Reservoir level variation, dam operation/interface, flow/current, wind, wave and weather limitations.
- Landing/jetty feasibility at Maikal, Payli and Tintni, including mooring, approach and emergency access.
- Vessel size/type assumptions, passenger capacity, speed, trip duration and navigation safety recommendations.
- Environmental, forest/wildlife, water-quality and social constraints identified in the study.
- Whether the study assessed the 67 km Maikal–Payli–Tintni water route, the separately described 90 km Bargi–Tindni stretch, or both.

A technical feasibility conclusion does not, by itself, constitute statutory permission to operate passenger vessels, approval of a particular vessel, land allotment, environmental clearance or financial/administrative sanction.

6. Requirements / Support Sought from Government

Sl.	Requirement / request raised by proponent	Concerned authority / examination
1	Lease/allotment or operating rights for MPT Maikal Resort, Bargi.	MPTB / MPSTDC or actual asset-owning agency; verify custody, current contract and applicable policy/selection procedure.
2	Lease/use of existing jetty at Maikal Resort.	Actual jetty owner/custodian and competent technical/navigation authority; verify title, condition and safe use.
3	Permission to operate cruise vessels on Bargi reservoir/backwaters of Narmada.	Competent State/inland-vessel/navigation authorities; identify statutory route, survey, registration, certification, manning and operating permissions.
4	Payli Old Guest House or suitable nearby land for a waterside halt.	NVDA / actual land-owning authority; verify land title, availability, reservoir constraints and allotment process.
5	Lease/use of jetty or landing facility near Tintni.	Actual land/jetty-owning agency and district administration; verify legal and physical status and road connectivity.
6	Lease/allotment or operating rights for MPT Jungle Resort, Sarhi.	MPTB / MPSTDC or actual asset owner; consult Forest/Wildlife authorities for site-specific restrictions.
7	Facilitation of approvals and interdepartmental coordination.	MPTB may coordinate within its mandate; statutory decisions remain with the respective competent authorities.
8	Consideration of investment facilitation / commercial arrangement.	Only after DPR, financial appraisal, public-asset valuation and legally permissible procurement/concession process.

7. Proposed Roles and Responsibilities

The following is a proposed responsibility matrix for examination and coordination only. It does not create a commitment or transfer statutory powers.

Stakeholder	Proposed role / responsibility	Boundary / safeguard
Project proponent: Arthmitra Advisors LLP	Submit signed proposal, authority letter, company credentials, DPR, investment plan, financial model, vessel designs, WAPCOS report, route map, land requirements, safety/environmental plans and implementation schedule; arrange its own surveys/consultants as required; bear costs unless formally sanctioned otherwise.	No right to public assets, route operation or construction until approvals and agreements are executed.
MPTB	Act as tourism-sector coordinating agency within its mandate; verify tourism asset ownership/custody with concerned entities; examine tourism concept, visitor experience, investment proposal and public-interest outcomes; obtain comments from asset-owning agencies; place a consolidated proposal before competent authority.	MPTB cannot independently grant land, navigation or forest/wildlife permissions where another authority is competent.

MPSTDC / concerned asset-owning agency	Provide verified status of Maikal and Sarhi properties, current operations/contracts, asset condition, inventory, revenue/occupancy information and applicable lease/management framework; examine feasibility of proposed use.	No direct allotment or exclusivity to be assured; follow applicable policy, valuation and procurement requirements.
NVDA / land-owning authority	Verify Payli/Harduli/island/shoreline land ownership, survey numbers, boundaries, encumbrances, reservoir-related restrictions and availability; indicate permissible land-use and formal allotment process.	Land allotment and reservoir-related permissions remain with competent authority and applicable law.
District administration / local bodies	Assist in land and site verification, revenue records, local access, public safety, law-and-order and interdepartmental coordination, as required.	Subject to jurisdiction and statutory powers.
Inland-vessel / navigation authorities	Examine route, vessel survey/registration/certification, crew qualifications, navigation safety, operating conditions and compliance under applicable inland-vessel law and rules.	Statutory technical and operational approvals cannot be substituted by tourism-sector recommendation.
Forest / Wildlife / Environment / Pollution Control authorities	Determine applicability of forest, protected-area, wildlife, environmental, pollution-control and waste-management permissions for the final site and activity plan.	No construction or activity in regulated/sensitive areas without prior applicable permissions.
Proponent's appointed operator / technical team	Operate only after approvals; maintain certified vessels, trained crew, passenger manifests, insurance, life-saving appliances, rescue arrangements, maintenance, incident reporting and approved SOPs.	Operations subject to inspection, permit conditions, weather restrictions and suspension directions.

8. Statutory, Safety and Environmental Examination

8.1 Inland vessel and navigation compliance

- Determine applicability of the Inland Vessels Act, 2021 and applicable Central/State rules, notifications and directions to the proposed route, vessels and operations.
- Confirm the competent authority and required sequence for vessel registration, survey, certification, route/area permission, manning and operation.
- Obtain vessel drawings, stability calculations, load line/freeboard basis, machinery/electrical and battery safety documentation, fire protection, lifesaving appliances and emergency equipment.
- Require licensed/qualified masters and crew, passenger manifest and capacity controls, pre-departure checklist, communications and shore-control arrangements.
- Require a dedicated rescue boat or approved rescue arrangement, trained responders, emergency access, evacuation drills, incident reporting and adequate insurance.
- Establish operating thresholds for wind, visibility, rainfall, water level, current and IMD alerts; define who has authority to cancel or suspend a trip.
- Ensure life jackets are worn by all passengers, including correctly sized child life jackets; no overloading and no sailing outside approved operating conditions.

8.2 Environmental, forest and wildlife safeguards

- Obtain site-wise jurisdiction map and determine whether any proposed activity falls within a protected area, forest land, eco-sensitive zone or other regulated area.
- Assess cumulative impacts of cruise traffic, noise, wake, lighting, anchoring, shoreline works, camping, water sports and visitor movement.
- Specify zero-discharge/approved sanitation, sewage and greywater management, solid-waste collection, no littering and pollution-response procedures.
- Avoid disturbance to nesting/roosting sites, wildlife movement and sensitive aquatic habitats; define speed, route and seasonal restrictions where required.
- No new construction, tree felling, island camping, night activity or expansion at Sarhi/shoreline sites should be presumed permissible from the concept deck.

9. Commercial and Implementation Information Required

Information required	Minimum particulars to be submitted

Project cost	Total project cost and site-wise capex; refurbishment versus new construction; vessel acquisition; jetty/terminal works; utilities; charging; safety systems; professional fees and contingencies.
Funding	Equity/debt mix, proof of funds, lender discussions, financing conditions and financial capacity of the proponent.
Operating model	Single integrated concession or separate site-wise arrangements; proposed operator; role of each consortium/member; subcontracting.
Commercial terms	Lease period requested, rent/premium, revenue share, minimum guarantee if any, user charges, tariff policy and public access arrangements.
Financial viability	Demand assumptions, passenger projections, seasonality, occupancy, pricing, operating costs, maintenance, break-even, sensitivity and downside scenarios.
Implementation	Phased milestones, minimum viable pilot, procurement plan, construction/renovation schedule and commissioning conditions.
Public interest	Local employment, local procurement, community participation, accessibility, safety, environmental performance and benefits to the regional tourism economy.
Risk allocation	Asset maintenance, insurance, damage, force majeure, regulatory change, service standards, performance security, default, termination and reversion.

10. Documents to be Obtained from the Project Proponent

- Signed detailed proposal addressed to the competent authority, company profile, LLP incorporation/registration details, PAN/GST details, authorised signatory proof and board/partner authorisation.
- Detailed Project Report (DPR) with site-wise scope, drawings, area statements, phasing, implementation schedule and project governance structure.
- Complete WAPCOS feasibility report, including technical annexures, survey drawings, maps and recommendations, together with any subsequent clarification/correspondence.
- Geo-referenced route map showing the exact route, chainage, coordinates, waterway distance, all proposed stops, jetties, islands and road-transfer segment.
- Reconciled route statement explaining the 67 km water route in the September 2026 deck and the separately cited 90 km Bargi Dam–Tindni route.
- Final vessel fleet plan, technical specifications, general arrangement drawings, passenger capacities, draft, propulsion, battery/charging plan, survey and certification pathway.
- Vessel-specific safety management plan, emergency response/rescue plan, crew qualifications, insurance proposal, passenger handling and operating SOPs.
- Site-wise land requirement schedule with khasra/survey numbers, area, ownership claimed, site plan, access and proposed use; no land rights should be presumed.
- Environment/forest/wildlife applicability assessment and proposed mitigation, waste, sanitation and pollution-control plans.
- Detailed capex, funding proof, financial model, demand study, proposed lease/concession structure and credentials/experience of the proponent and proposed operator.
- Written expressions of interest/credentials from any proposed hospitality or operating partners, including Anay Banquets, Jabalpur, if they remain part of the current proposal.

11. Contact and Project Coordination Details

Particular	Details / status
Project proponent	Shri Ashish Mahawar
Organisation	Arthmitra Advisors LLP
Role	Presenter / project proponent for the proposed Maikal–Sarhi circuit
Presentation	“From Maikal’s waters to Sarhi’s wild”, September 2026
Telephone / mobile	Not available in the documents examined; obtain from the signed proposal / official contact sheet.
Email	Not available in the documents examined; obtain from the signed proposal / official contact sheet.
Registered office / correspondence address	Not available in the documents examined; obtain LLP profile / signed proposal.

Potential hospitality investor separately indicated	Anay Banquets, Jabalpur; written expression of interest, legal entity details and role to be confirmed.

12. Suggested Agenda for the Meeting

1. Presentation of the proposed Narmada Cruise and Eco-Tourism Circuit connecting Jabalpur (Bargi) – Payli – Tintni/Tindni – Sarhi (Kanha).
2. Presentation of the WAPCOS feasibility study, route alignment, technical findings and operating limitations.
3. Discussion on the proposed use/upgradation of MPT Maikal Resort, existing jetty, Payli Guest House/nearby land, Tintni landing and MPT Jungle Resort Sarhi.
4. Examination of cruise vessel concepts, passenger capacity, route operations, navigability, safety, rescue arrangements and environmental safeguards.
5. Identification of land ownership, asset custody, statutory permissions and the role of MPTB, MPSTDC, NVDA and other competent departments/agencies.
6. Discussion on proposed investment, project cost, financing, implementation model, concession/lease structure and operational responsibilities.
7. Finalisation of documents to be submitted by the proponent and further technical/site-level examination required.

13. Suggested Directions / Decisions for Chair's Consideration

8. The presentation may be taken on record as a preliminary project concept, without implying in-principle approval, land allotment, lease, exclusive rights, navigation permission or financial commitment.
9. The proponent may be requested to submit a signed comprehensive DPR and all supporting documents listed in Section 10 within a time limit decided in the meeting.
10. The proponent may be directed to provide the complete WAPCOS feasibility report. The concerned technical agency may examine the report and confirm its applicability to the proposed route, vessel type and operating season.
11. MPTB/concerned asset-owning agency may obtain and verify the present status, ownership/custody, operation, contracts and availability of Maikal and Sarhi tourism assets.
12. NVDA and the relevant land-owning authority may be requested to confirm the ownership, land schedule, availability and restrictions for Payli, Harduli, Old Payli/Lanka Islands and other proposed sites, as applicable.
13. A joint site inspection/technical meeting may be considered after receipt of the DPR, WAPCOS report and geo-referenced route map.
14. The relevant inland-vessel/navigation, district, environment, forest and wildlife authorities may be consulted on matters falling within their jurisdiction.
15. After receipt of complete documents and interdepartmental comments, a consolidated examination note may be placed before the competent authority for further decision on the permissible project development and selection mechanism.

14. Matters on Which No Commitment Should Be Made at This Stage

- Grant, lease, transfer, allotment or exclusive use of MPT Maikal Resort, MPT Jungle Resort Sarhi, any jetty, guest house, island or government land.
- Permission to navigate, operate passenger cruises, conduct water sports, camping or overnight stays.
- Assurance of government funding, subsidy, viability-gap funding, guaranteed traffic, minimum revenue or commercial returns.
- Approval for construction, renovation beyond permissible scope, tree felling, land-use change or activity in forest/protected/ecologically sensitive areas.
- Acceptance of the proponent's vessel specifications, passenger capacity, route distance, trip duration, cost estimates or revenue projections without verification.
- Direct allotment or exclusivity without following the applicable policy, valuation, tender/PPP or other legally permissible process.

15. Preliminary Action-Taken / Action-Point Sheet

Sl.	Action point	Responsibility (proposed)	Target date / status
1	Submit signed proposal, LLP profile and authorised signatory documents.	Project proponent	To be fixed

2	Submit complete WAPCOS feasibility report and annexures.	Project proponent	To be fixed
3	Submit reconciled route map (67 km / 90 km discrepancy) and site coordinates.	Project proponent	To be fixed
4	Submit DPR, financial model, vessel details and safety plan.	Project proponent	To be fixed
5	Verify Maikal and Sarhi asset ownership, current operation and contract status.	Concerned asset-owning agency / MPTB coordination	To be fixed
6	Verify Payli/Harduli/island/Tintni land and jetty status.	NVDA / concerned land-owning authority / district administration	To be fixed
7	Obtain technical comments on route and vessels under applicable inland-vessel framework.	Competent navigation / inland-vessel authority	After receipt of documents
8	Determine environmental, forest and wildlife approval requirements.	Concerned statutory authorities	After receipt of site plans
9	Prepare consolidated examination note for competent authority.	MPTB	After receipt of comments

16. Source Documents, Assumptions and Caveats

- Primary source: “From Maikal’s waters to Sarhi’s wild”, Arthmitra Advisors LLP, September 2026, 56-page concept presentation.
- Internal reference: “MPTB_Narmada_Cruise_Circuit_Officials_Briefing_Dossier_05Nov2026.docx”, prepared for the proposed meeting on 05 November 2026.
- Internal reference: “Maikal_Sarhi_Project_Summary_Requirements_Responsibilities.docx”, previously prepared summary of project scope, requirements, roles and approvals.
- Supplementary project inputs supplied for the Bargi Dam–Tindni cruise proposal, including the stated 90 km route, Harduli–Payli–Old Payli Island–Lanka Island–Tindni alignment, proposed land bank and alternate fleet concept.
- WAPCOS feasibility study: informed to have been undertaken and to have found the route technically feasible; the final report itself was not available among the materials examined while preparing this note. Its findings must be verified from the signed report.
- All project cost, route, vessel, land, passenger, timing and investment particulars are indicative or proponent-supplied unless independently verified. Proposed roles and directions are recommendations for consideration and are not agreed contractual obligations.

Prepared for official examination and consideration

Madhya Pradesh Tourism Board, Bhopal